

Delaware County Budget Hearings September 8th 2023

Segment #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fZ0XHZT93Cw
Publication Date	2023-09-08T17:16:28Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Budget Hearing & Meeting Summary

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Budget Hearings (Day 3) [00:07:16](#)
- **Summary of Discussion:** The board continued departmental budget reviews from previous sessions to identify spending cuts and manage the county's financial deficit. Discussions centered around balancing various tax levy funds (including health, clerk, election boards, courts, and the auditor's office), evaluating salary lines, managing computer replacement cycles, and reviewing state-funded grants and matching contributions.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Convened as Day 3 of the county budget hearings by the presiding officer [00:07:16](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Presiding officers, board members (including Ryan, Dan, Jim, Bill, Gene, and Becky), and financial staff (Tanya, Auditor/Ed, and Jessica).

- *Members Absent:* Not explicitly detailed in roll call, though specific members/officials entered or departed during discussions.
- *Presiding Officer:* Unnamed lead chair conducting the budget hearings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not discussed.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:09:16 Health Department (Board of Health Fund 1159 & Health Services Fund)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie (Board of Health representative) / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed whether potential departmental give-backs for the current year impact the County General fund (determined to be a tax levy fund rather than County General, making some give-backs moot for general fund relief). Reviewed state health grant revenues (\$1,350,344 due to four counties opting out) and maintained 2024 budget numbers at reduced/bare-bones levels.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** 2024 figures accepted / Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:19:10 Clerk's Department Budget (Fund 125)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (Clerk) / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed staffing levels, salary line discrepancies based on 2023 payroll vs. proposed 2024 figures, and office supplies. Addressed a computer equipment replacement cycle (10 computers/year to stay under warranty and match state software requirements) and agreed to split \$15,000 in computer costs via a perpetuation fund transfer (\$7,500). Noted significant current-year give-backs from the clerk's office.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Office supplies and part-time lines kept at 2023 levels; computer equipment budget adjusted; overall budget adjusted and Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:47:57 Election Board Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (Clerk/Election Board) / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed municipal election reimbursements, anticipated 2023 year-end reversions/give-backs to the general fund (~\$150,000), increased postage and part-time hours due to the upcoming presidential election year, legal services lines, and voting machine upgrades/printers. Microvote offered a three-year interest-free payment plan for new voting machines (\$22,334/year); printers

were temporarily removed pending further review of state grants and commissioner sign-off.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Voting machine three-year payment plan accepted; printers tabled for review; budget adjusted to \$639,534 and Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:24:54 Clerk Perpetuation & Non-General Funds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (Clerk) / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed staffing, health insurance line items, and database/storage maintenance fees outside of County General.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:32:03 CASA Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed the CASA program director's salary raise (proposed 7.8% match increase to \$46,810, partially offset by a state match grant) and grant depletion concerns.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Salary adjustment incorporated for review/approval, budget finalized at \$216,745 (subject to final auditing), Approved by Voice Vote.
- **02:00:34 Courts Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily / Jeff (Chief Probation Officer) / Judges / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed judicial salaries, master commissioner/magistrate positions, probation officer state-mandated salary increases (7.8%), jury trial fees, psychological testing (psych) fees, zoom software accounts, and the JUMP program coordinator position. Agreed to fund the JUMP coordinator position (partially matched by city edit funds up to \$30,000) and reclassify a secretarial position into a juvenile case manager/intake officer role utilizing user fees. Eliminated one new probation officer request (163) and the IRX coordinator grant request.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reductions made to equipment, travel, and unneeded requests; final court budget set at \$2,646,322 and Approved by Voice Vote.
- **03:34:00 Auditor<U+2019>s Office Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor<U+2019>s Office Staff / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed line-by-line figures, zeroed out a proposed grant writer/administrator position (\$37,500) due to revenue timing, reduced office supplies and mileage, adjusted contractual services to account for prior August appropriations, and updated staff salary lines.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Final auditor budget set at \$713,970 and Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **04:01:00 County Council Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed council member training, memberships, office supplies, and salary adjustments. Council members agreed to zero out salary adjustment lines and miscellaneous supplies for the current year as a gesture of leadership.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Council budget set at \$412,340 and Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No open public comment period or general citizen forum was conducted during this departmental budget work session.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Total department give-backs for 2023 calculated at \$121,960 to help offset the general fund deficit.
 - The board noted an ongoing gap requiring further cuts of approximately \$1.68 million to reach the target budget of ~\$36.14 million ahead of budget adoption.
 - **Next Meeting Scheduled:** Thursday, September 14th at 1:00 PM **04:21:48**.
 - **Adjournment:** Official recess/adjournment until the next scheduled session **04:24:26**.
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